

The Glorious King of Tantras: The Precious Garland

Śrī Ratnamālā Tantra Rāja · Toh 389 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་རྒྱལ་པོ་ཆེན་པོའི་རྒྱལ་པོ་

The Glorious King of Tantras, the Precious Garland, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Ratnamālā Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as the Dpal Rin Chen Phreng Ba'i Rgyud Kyi Rgyal Po, is a Buddhist tantric text belonging to the class of Highest Yoga Tantra associated with the Cakrasaṃvara cycle. It takes the form of a dialogue in which a goddess petitions Vajradhara to explain the meaning of the "precious garland" — a threefold teaching concerning the jewel of the vessel-world, the jewel of sentient beings, and a third jewel transcending both — as it relates to the practice of Cakrasaṃvara. The text is Toh 389 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the tantras, and its opening homage to Glorious Mahāsukha situates it firmly within the bliss-centered soteriology characteristic of the Cakrasaṃvara tantric tradition.

In the language of India: Śrī Ratnamālā Tantra Rāja. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious King of Tantras, the Precious Garland. Homage to Glorious Mahāsukha.

The goddess petitioned: O Vajradhara,
in the glorious Cakrasaṃvara
the meaning of the Precious Garland I have not understood —
I beg you, please explain it to me.

The Blessed One declared: Listen, goddess of long-eyed gaze,
in the glorious Cakrasaṃvara
what has not been taught, I will explain to you.

The precious jewel is of three kinds,
and its garland likewise is of three kinds.

The first is the precious jewel of the vessel-world.

The second is the precious jewel of the essence-beings.

The third jewel is that which is free from the nature of both vessel and essence.

The goddess petitioned: Blessed One,
you have spoken of three kinds —
in what way are these precious jewels?

In what way is the garland of each?

And for whom are they the domain of practice?

The Blessed One declared: The first, the precious jewel of the vessel-world, is to be understood as fivefold.

The first is a great white kakuru stone,
blessed by Akṣobhya,
its shape resembling a crescent moon,
its finest size like a goose egg.

This is the Blazing Jewel.

Anoint it with the milk of a white cow, white goat, and white sheep,
purify it well, and offer it to Akṣobhya.

This is to be placed upon the crown of the head,
and performed at every occasion of offering without exception.
It overcomes afflicting spirits of the east,
and protects whoever possesses it.

The medium grade is roughly the size of an egg from another bird.

This is the Wholesome Jewel.

Pour in two kinds of mercury,
ensure that the accompanying substances are complete,
insert it into the mouth,
press it with the tongue at the wheel of Romā,
then move it gradually,
and at the tip of the secret vajra,
when great bliss has just arisen,
press the tongue-wheel with longing.

Just as when one has eaten snake-flesh,
by pressing the head it emerges from the back,
likewise, by this pressing, the awakening mind
turns back upward even from the tip of the nose,
remaining as sesame within sesame oil.

In particular, bliss arises in an upward direction.

Because it bestows bliss, it is called a precious jewel,
and its garland has been explained as manifold.

The smallest is roughly the size of the ovum of a young queen bee.

If the five medicines — eraṇa and the others — are bound to the crown of the head,

they eliminate the wrinkles of the body.

The second, properly so called, is lapis lazuli, blue,
blessed by the jewel-born Ratnasambhava,
its shape like a willow leaf,
its finest size like an elephant's eye.

This is the Jewel Sprout.

Mix it with a goose egg, dongro, and pangshama — three ingredients —
and hang it from the right ear as an ornament.

It is declared to overcome afflicting spirits of the south,
and protects whoever possesses it.

The medium grade is roughly the size of a goose egg.

This is the Jewel Eraṇḍa.

Pour camphor, rakta, and mercury — three substances — into it,
and introduce it upward and downward through the nose and the underside of
the tongue.

By this, awakening mind is seized,
remaining like a sickle-wheel of fire.

The smallest is just the size of a sparrow's egg complete.

Mix arura, kyuru, baru, and dongro together,
apply and rub it upon the body.

This is the dhañdhaka spurge —

it causes the insects of the body to separate and depart.

The third, properly so called, is red lotus-ruby,
its shape round,

blessed by Amitābha,
its finest size one thousand kārṣāpaṇas.

Mix saffron and camphor — five parts —
anoint and apply it to that jewel,
place it at the center of the navel and bind it there.

This is the Ratna Kerura.

It is declared to overcome afflicting spirits of the west.

The medium grade is one kārṣāpaṇa.

This is the Ratna Kara.

Five substances — butter, rice bran, and the rest —
worked into mercury prepared in the craft-form,
pour that inside it and press it at the navel.

By this, awakening mind is seized,
just as water placed upon water.
The smallest is one kārṣāpaṇa.
The three fruits, ruta, and —
mixed with the essence of butter,
concealed at the crown of the head —
this is the Ratna Devasa.
It causes grey hair to cease.

Then the fourth genuine one:
it is an emerald, green in color,
square in shape.
Consecrated with the blessing of Amoghasiddhi (Skt. Amoghasiddhi, "the
Unfailing Achiever"),
it accomplishes aims.
The finest grade is about the size of a belo stick.
This is the Ratna Gagani.
Anoint it with the five roots together with their branches,
and hang it on the left ear.
By this, afflicting spirits of the north are overcome.
The medium grade is about the size of a hen's egg.
The Great God (Śiva) and Umā —
anoint it with the camphor and vermilion of both,
and insert it inside the navel.
It seizes both the camphor of Sinhala and the other.
The smallest is about the size of an egg from another birth.
Yellow turmeric, gold — these three —
give one measure of the mixture:
this is the Eruna Rasa.
It brings ease and no insects are born.
This is the Ratna Sandaha.

Then the fifth genuine one:
it appears in many colors and shapes.
Consecrated with the blessing of Vairocana,
it accomplishes many aims severally.

The goddess asked: Blessed One,
in future times, how shall individual people
seek out the places where jewels are found?
And how do they fail to find jewels?
How is a precious jewel to be examined?

The Blessed One declared: Beyond the great ocean
there is an island of jewels.

One should seek them from that place.
Furthermore, the places where jewels are found —
gold, silver, and the rest, and stones —
are said to exist everywhere.

The five ways of knowing jewels are these.
The first is knowing without confusion
all the tantras — knowing through the oral instructions of a teacher.
The second is knowing through one who is endowed with meditative practice.
The third is knowing through a great merchant
who has entered into the oral instructions of the tradition.
The fourth is known by a great king
endowed with all virtuous qualities.
The fifth is understood by a skilled goldsmith
connected with a king and a skilled yogin.

The goddess asked: Blessed One,
what is the first oral instruction?
What is the second, the practice?
What is the third, the tradition?
What are the fourth's virtuous qualities?
And what is the fifth connection?

The Blessed One declared: The first, knowing through oral instruction,
is recognizing a jewel's single essential nature
in its many qualities —
just as with the assay-stone of a substance:
that it does not sink in water, it punctures and so forth —
knowing its many properties is the oral instruction.

Knowing through practice is single-pointed.
By that, everything is known.
Knowing the meaning of the tradition —

that is what a merchant knows.

The king who is endowed with all virtuous qualities
knows mantras, traditions, and so forth.

The king connected with the yogin
knows the vapor of gold beneath the earth —
that is what the goldsmith knows.

Examination is of two kinds:
direct perception and signs.

By means of a vajra assay-stone and the rest,
and by means of the eranda plant and so forth —
this is settled by direct perception.

The Mahānīla and the rest
overcome afflicting spirits and protect the gods,
restore broken commitments (samaya),
and bring about the lengthening of lives, and so forth.

First, the signs of an afflicting spirit
must be examined and understood by one who is skilled.
Then, for the signs of that afflicting spirit,
the very rite itself should be performed according to the proper method.

Then, at a clean spring,
cast a torma (ritual cake), and take up the pure water.

Pour water into a vessel of gold or silver.

For whichever it may be — a god, a nāga, a yakṣa, or the rest —
the yogin should set it upon the maṇḍala of the two signs.

It should be traversed with three steps.

On the left maṇḍala, atop it,
place a mirror inside the water.

Outside, place one part of the torma.

Inside, divide it off with a white curtain.

There, set out the feast-offering and the auspicious substances.

The yogin, having bathed his limbs,
completes the divine meditative practice of the deity,
sharply seals the boundary with a wrathful one,
and meditates on a great wrathful goddess as the deity.

By this, the first jewel is seized.

Then, let it hang down four finger-widths.

Whether it is able or unable to act and so forth —
this should be examined and understood by one who is skilled.
The shape, the color, the precious jewel —

How could there be a jewel without qualities? For example, if a single child is born, how could there be no father? Therefore, the skilled one should examine it.

The goddess inquired of the Blessed One: "How is it with gold, silver, and the rest?"

The Blessed One declared: "Gold is of two kinds — that which is so by intrinsic nature, and that which is made by craft. That which is so by intrinsic nature deceives death. That which is made by craft is of two kinds: alchemical gold and golden ornament. Refined gold blocks the path of conditioned existence. Years and months, half a month — the skilled one should examine and understand this. Silver and the rest are likewise. In brief, all substances that appear and exist are precious jewels. One who holds the oral instructions should know this.

Then, the precious jewel of essences: at the Mount Meru of the body, the distinctions of precious gold — skillful means and wisdom as precious jewels. Wisdom is the intrinsic nature of the central channel; skillful means is the awakening mind. The red and clear is wisdom; the white and clear is declared to be skillful means. From the precious avadhūtī, a rosary of many bindus arises.

The goddess inquired of the Blessed One: 'How is it with the avadhūtī?'

The Blessed One declared: 'From the intrinsic nature of the avadhūtī, the five gates abide perfectly above; in the middle and below it is likewise. From generation, completion, and intrinsic nature arise the defining marks of qualities and faults. The great-bliss bindu is the syllable HŪṂ. OM and ĀḤ HŪṂ — together with HA, these four make up the wheel of great bliss: body, speech, mind, and great bliss — correctly taught as the four blazings. Body, speech, mind, and great bliss — entering as four at the throat; dripping as four at the heart; and likewise as four in the emanation body. The dharmakāya in the precious jewel is taught as a rosary of sixteen emptinesses.

Then, the meaning of the most secret: the lotus and vajra, the two of them, the precious avadhūtī — A, PHAṬ, E, and VAM, these four: the four secret

bindus. A is like a mirror. PHAṬ is diligent activity. E is individual analysis. VAM is the wisdom of equality. The precious wisdom of the dharmadhātu: liberation, emptiness, major marks, and likewise the minor marks. From A arise the four wheels and the four elements. At the seat of PHAṬ reside the five wisdoms. At the seat of E reside the nine absorptions (samādhis). At the seat of VAM reside the fifty-eight. Know these as they truly are. KṢA, OM, E, TA — the four seeds: through the defining marks of qualities and faults they pervade everything; this should be known.

The goddess inquired of the Blessed One: 'By this, how are spirits overcome? How is the bodhicitta blocked? How are white hairs and wrinkles pacified?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Conceptual thought is the spirit. Abandoning the major and minor marks, the five aggregates become the five nectars; the sense bases become five likewise. The elements are the nature of the support; those same are the nature of the essence-elixir. For the purpose of abandoning conceptual thought — the precious jewel. The process of blocking the bodhicitta: by the right stretched out, through skillful means; by the left, wisdom — blocking the knot of the channel. By the teeth and the sky, block it. By the rounded one, block it at the tip of the secret lotus. In some teachings, the nāḍī and rasanā enter within the avadhūtī — that is the rounded space. As an example, just as in the two tongues of a snake there are both poison and medicine: by means of a particular posture, one should know the application of blocking.

The support of the blocking: the breath and the vital wind. Thus abiding in the center, gradually drawing upward stage by stage — from a single moment up to a year — one blocks the intrinsic nature of white hairs and wrinkles, according to the measure on which it depends.

The goddess inquired of the Blessed One: 'How does one abide in the center? How does one draw upward stage by stage?'

The Blessed One declared: 'Skillful means is called the extreme of permanence. Wisdom is called the extreme of annihilation. The entrance into equanimity is the meaning of the Middle Way. The breath on the right is the extreme of permanence; the wind-effort on the left is the extreme of annihilation.

The abiding of those two is the meaning of the Middle Way.

The roma is the bodhicitta of permanence;
the kyangma is blood, which is annihilation.

Whatever abides in the avadhūtī
is to be understood as the Middle Way.

Supreme joy is the extreme of permanence;
the joy of separation is the extreme of intoxication;
co-emergent joy is taught as the Middle Way.

Oṃ and Hūṃ are the two extremes;
the aspect of Āḥ abides as the Middle Way.
Āli and Kāli are the two extremes;
the neuter syllable is the Middle Way.

Male and female are the two extremes;
the neither-one-nor-the-other is taught as beyond duality.
This is the meditation of union;
this is the meaning of abiding in the Middle Way.

The Perfection of Wisdom
is taught as the union of relatedness.
The Kriyā tantra and the Yoga tantra —
their manifestations are taught as union.

In the glorious Guhyasamāja,
union enters through the upper gate's wind.
In the Prajñā Yoga,
union enters through Śrī Laṅkā and camphor.

Drawing upward stage by stage —
at the secret wheel, the ā:
the measure of bliss being complete
is understood as the closing of the lotus and the vajra.
That is the measure of full completion.

Then from the secret wheel
one draws upward as far as the great-bliss wheel.
First, one should understand it thus.
Once the mind has become stable in this way,
from the great-bliss wheel
one draws upward to the tip of the secret nose.

The goddess then asked the Blessed One: "Where does the jewel of vital
essence dwell? Who knows the knowing of it? And what is the method of

examining it?"

The Blessed One declared: "From the crown of the head at the brahmarandhra down as far as the secret wheel, the avadhūtī dwells there like sandalwood. In some it abides like a coiled snake on the ground; in others it abides like a coiled rope. These all abide by their intrinsic nature throughout the whole body. These channels and wheels are taught as buddha-nature. The outer channels and the inner channels, and the secret and the ultimate — so it is taught, through the existence of pith instructions, that they are to be known. The examination is presented in two kinds: the first is examination of the body, the second is to be understood as pure knowing."

As for the body, there are two aspects: the general and the particular.

The intrinsic nature is wind.

Short limbs indicate the water element.

Extended limbs indicate the earth element.

A large lower frame indicates the fire element.

Great variety indicates the space element.

In general, whiteness is the water element;

redness is to be understood as fire;

yellowness is likewise the earth element;

blueness is to be understood as wind.

Or again, it may be the wind element:

if heat is great, it is the fire element;

if stable, it is taught as the earth element;

if the moisture element predominates, it is the water element;

when all of these are present, it is the space element.

Entry is the ground of great bliss;

the reverse — emanation — is taught as water.

In the Yoga tantra, one should understand through the particular the dwelling-place of mind.

Śukra and wind are Śrī Laṅkā's fire;

snake and Dharma are a counterpart.

Other matters too are to be known by the wise.

Then the three signs taught as particular —

shape, color, and mark —

all are to be known by the wise.

First, the examination of shape:
the shape at the forehead has four aspects —
square, round, crescent,
and triangular, so it is to be known.

White and so forth are likewise.
From the ear to the foot,
all are to be examined and known.

The voice — fine or coarse,
long or short in utterance,
trembling and the other particulars —
are to be examined and known by the wise.

The marks examined by these signs
are to be known as threefold:
attachment is understood as the body,
aversion as the mind,
and delusion as the speech.

The first — the categorization of attachment —
has three divisions: the waxing phase, the waning phase, and the junction.
Through shape, color, and voice, all three,
the wise one examines the arising of desire.

Four intervals by day and four intervals by night,
and likewise each single moment —
all are to be examined and known by the wise.

The eyes narrowing, goosebumps arising, and the like
are the signs of desire arising in terms of shape.
The form born of desire is somewhat reddish;
the nostrils are white, and so forth,

A trembling voice, a dry mouth, and so on
are declared to be signs of desire arising in terms of sound.
Beyond that, the signs of desire in its waxing phase
are to be examined through color and shape.

Because attachment is firm, it is the earth element;
water and the rest are likewise to be understood.
These same signs are also to be known with respect to speech and mind.

The goddess asked the Blessed One: What is called attachment? What is the greater form of it? What are aversion and the rest like? And what are body, speech, and mind like?

The Blessed One declared: Attachment, as an affliction, is saṃsāra. By clinging to concealed secrets while setting aside the manifest secrets, and because the seed of existence is not deep, it is like an arrow shot from a bow — its fruit is birth in the Avīci hell.

The greater form is non-conceptual by nature and produces non-dual wisdom. What is called attachment is to be abandoned; its greater form is taught as the antidote. What is called attachment is like a flower; its greater form is like a fragrance.

Further distinctions should be known. Aversion and the rest are analogous to the above. All of these, with the body as their support, are shown through body; shown through speech as free from expression; and understood through mind as free from conceptual thought.

Conceptual thought is small and the capacity for letting go is great; reverence for the guru is great and compassion is great; and furthermore, one who knows all the distinctions — to such a person this is taught, but it is to be kept secret from all others.

A guru who possesses all qualities, who knows the connection between empowerment and pith instruction, who is unconfused regarding the meaning of the secret, who is endowed with great compassion, who has no miserliness regarding the Dharma, who speaks clearly and plainly, who is honored by all those of his lineage, who holds the mudrā of karma, who possesses samaya — to such a guru one shows respect. It is not the case that one should attend upon and show reverence to everyone.

Then the third jewel is non-dual and innately born — free from conceptual thought and free from conceptual elaboration. Realizing that is the garland of jewels.

The goddess asked the Blessed One: What is called the manifest? How does its fruit ripen? What is called the concealed? And what is its fruit?

The Blessed One declared: What is called the manifest is gnosis — the thirty-seven bodies, speeches, and minds, the three bodies of the dharmakāya, saṃbhogakāya, and nirmāṇakāya — in brief, subsumed into the four joys. The condition of meditative focus is the secret. Because it is

endowed with seven, it is great.

Without entering by the power of the antidotes to the thirty-seven and so forth, the concealed — the lotus and vajra together — when one enters into union, desire arises. This is the unreliable thief. For example, just as all branches and blossoms grow from the root of a tree, so from attachment, which is the root of the afflictions, the three poisons and all the rest arise.

The concealed secret is saṃsāra; the manifest is taught as nirvāṇa. Saṃsāra is the Avīci hell, and the eight charnel grounds, filled with arrogant beings who have no compassion and eat flesh and blood — dwelling there is like a wheel of a chariot spinning on.

Nirvāṇa is the three bodies. Although the Protector has passed into nirvāṇa, he turns the wheel in the manner of saṃsāra and, by the force of the assembly's power, enters correctly into the benefit of sentient beings.

The dharmakāya, free from conceptual elaboration, is like space. The two form bodies are like clouds and rain; the two bodies accomplish the benefit of sentient beings by the power of the karma and aspiration of sentient beings. From the appearance arising through that power, there is nothing that can appear in reality itself.

The three bodies themselves are the meaning of the forty. The charnel grounds and so on are to be understood as symbolic indications. Thirty-two are the symbolic indications of the dharmakāya; eight are the symbolic indications of the two form bodies.

Furthermore, the specific symbolic indications are these: the thick one is the symbolic indication of the secret vajra; the wrathful goddess is the symbolic indication of the secret lotus; bent and straight indicate quality and fault; resting upon the index finger, the little finger indicates "come to my side"; resting upon the thumb, the middle finger —

— indicates "come to your side." The thumb and index finger forming a triangle are the symbolic indication of the lotus or a question. Showing a rounded shape indicates the expanded lotus. The gathering at the place of bliss — whether at dusk, midnight, or dawn — is indicated from the first knuckle of the finger down to the last. By the blessing of body, speech, and mind, press firmly up to three times. The further specific symbolic indications, which have not been taught in all the tantras, are to be understood from color, shape, and the mode of the limbs likewise.

The abiding posture is the method's way of sitting. The attendant is said to be wisdom's way of sitting. The field is the method's company of provisions for eating; likewise wisdom's proximate field. The gathering is the coming of method; the coming of wisdom is the proximate gathering. Chandoha is the method's seat and ornament; wisdom likewise is the proximate chandoha. The charnel ground is method free from conceptual elaboration; likewise wisdom is the proximate charnel ground. Furthermore, the further specific symbolic indications are to be understood from color, from shape likewise, and from the mode of the limbs.

Thereupon the goddess and the others made various offerings and, having offered, disappeared from sight.

The great king of tantras called the Glorious Jewel Garland, which is the secret — the naturally secret — is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the supplied passage. The translation ends accordingly.

Several pharmacological and material terms appear in this passage that belong to a specialized Indo-Tibetan medical and tantric ritual vocabulary. "Kakuru" is a Sanskrit loan for a type of crystal or precious stone; its precise mineralogical identity is uncertain. "Dongro" renders the Tibetan "ldong ros," a plant used in Tibetan medicine sometimes identified as Clematis or a related genus. "Pangshama" renders "spang sha ma," a Tibetan medicinal plant not securely identified in Western botanical literature. "Romā's wheel" refers to a subtle-body channel-wheel (cakra) associated with the Romā channel in the Cakrasaṃvara tantric physiology. "Dhañdhaka spurge" renders the Sanskrit loan term transliterated in the Tibetan as "dhañdhaka," a plant in the Euphorbia family used in Indian medicine. "Kārṣāpaṇa" is an ancient Indian unit of weight and currency retained as a technical measure. "Rakta" here likely refers to a red medicinal substance, possibly red sandalwood or a similar resin, rather than blood in this context, though the term is ambiguous. The passage as a whole is a tantric medical-ritual text detailing the preparation and use of precious stones as ritual implements and medicinal agents within the Cakrasaṃvara system.

- The passage contains a series of proper names that are Sanskrit transliterations in the Tibetan text itself, not translated Tibetan terms. These include Ratna Devasa, Ratna Gagani, Ratna Sandaha, Eruna Rasa, and Mahānīla. They are rendered as found, since the Tibetan is phonetically transcribing Sanskrit technical names from a jewel-science context.

"Belo stick" renders the Tibetan term for a kind of measuring stick or stick used in traditional South Asian contexts; its exact size is uncertain.

"Camphor of Sinhala" refers to camphor from Sri Lanka, a well-known trade commodity in classical sources.

The phrase rendered "another birth" in "an egg from another birth" follows the Tibetan literally; the technical sense may refer to a bird species defined by its mode of birth, used as a size

comparison.

- The term *avadhūtī* is a Sanskrit loanword used in tantric physiology for the central channel; it is left in Sanskrit throughout as the text itself uses it as a technical proper name.

The phrase rendered "alchemical gold and golden ornament" renders a distinction between gold produced by alchemical transformation and gold fashioned into jewelry; the first kind is associated with blocking conditioned existence and extending life.

The phrase "the rounded one blocks it at the tip of the secret lotus" is a euphemism for a tantric physical technique involving the tip of the tongue pressed to the palate; the passage intentionally layers physiological and symbolic meanings.

The term "la la" in "some teachings, the nāḍī and rasanā" renders a qualifier meaning "in certain versions" or "according to some"; the nāḍī here refers to the right channel (iḍā/lalanā) and rasanā to the left channel, standard tantric channel terminology.

The fifty-eight at the seat of VAM likely refers to the fifty-eight wrathful deities of the maṇḍala cycle, though it could also be a count of bindus or syllables; this is a genuine doctrinal ambiguity in the passage.

- The channel names roma, kyangma, and avadhūtī are standard Vajrayāna subtle-body terms (Skt. rasodhāra / lalanā, rasanā, and avadhūtī respectively). They have been left in their Tibetan-derived or Sanskrit forms as is conventional in English-language tantric literature, since no transparent English rendering exists.

The passage's reference to "Śrī Laṅkā and camphor" (śimhala and karpūra) is a tantric technical usage; the pairing likely designates specific substances or yogic correlates rather than the island and the spice literally.

The phrase rendered "closing of the lotus and the vajra" describes the yogic sign of bliss reaching fullness at the secret wheel, a standard Anuttarayoga completion-stage indicator.

"Neuter syllable" renders *ma ning yi ge*, a technical reference to the androgyne or neither-male-nor-female category in the syllable taxonomy of tantric phonology.

- The passage describes a tantric symbolic system in which anatomical gestures and finger signs carry encoded meanings. The phrase rendered "come to my side" for the little-finger gesture is a contextual interpretation of the Tibetan "ཁོ་གླིང་དུ་བཞུགས་པར་བྱེད་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་སྒྲུབ་," which literally means "come here to my opposite side" or "come to face me." The translation preserves the sense of an inviting gesture signal within the coded finger-language being described.

The "thirty-seven" mentioned in connection with bodies, speeches, and minds likely refers to the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening, reframed here in tantric symbolic register. The "four joys" are the standard Vajrayāna fourfold scheme of joy, supreme joy, special joy, and innate joy.

The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the final line, reflecting the provided excerpt ending.

- The term "chandoḥa" (Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit chandoḥa) is a technical term from the tantric context denoting a gathering or assembly site associated with tantric practice; it appears twice and is left in its Sanskrit form as it has no standard English equivalent and the Tibetan simply transliterates it. The colophon phrase "naturally secret" (rang bzhin gyis gsang ba) distinguishes the text's secrecy as intrinsic rather than merely conventional or imposed.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.